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◆ AI Overview



The difference between a GRE math score at the 73rd percentile (scaled score 157) and a perfect score (scaled score 170) is **13 scaled points**, representing a jump from outperforming 73% of test-takers to about the 92nd–96th percentile. [PrepScholar +5](#)

Score Breakdown

- **73rd Percentile Score:** A scaled score of **157** out of 170.
- **Perfect Score:** A scaled score of **170** out of 170.
- **Point Difference:** Exactly **13 points** on the ETS 130–170 scale. [PrepScholar +3](#)

Percentile and Competitiveness Comparison

- **At 157 (73rd Percentile):** You score better than 73% of all test-takers. This is common for non-STEM fields, but often low for competitive engineering or physical sciences programs. [PrepScholar +2](#)
- **At 170 (Perfect Score):** You score better than roughly 92% to 96% of test-takers (depending on the specific annual cohort data). Because many applicants score high on the math section, a perfect 170 does not reach the 99th percentile like a perfect verbal score does. [Test Ninjas +1](#)
- **Accuracy Requirement:** Reaching 170 requires near-flawless or total accuracy across the quantitative section, whereas a 157 allows for multiple incorrect answers. [PrepScholar](#)

If you are preparing your graduate applications, tell me your **target field of study** or **specific university goals** so I can help you figure out if you need to close that 13-point gap.



12 sites



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Manhattan Review

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Overview of GRE Score Percentiles

For example, a percentile ranking **of** 80% means you earned a better **score** than 80% **of** other test takers, while 20% **of** test-takers scored higher than you.



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What are **GRE score** percentiles? Table **for** percentile **scores** in verbal, **quantitative** and analytical writing sections. How are they calculated?



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<https://www.ets.org> › gre › scores › understand-scores

Understanding Your GRE General Test Scores

The following resources will help you gain a better understanding **of** what your **scores** mean and how we advise institutions to use them.



Stacy Blackman Consulting

<https://www.stacyblackman.com> › gre-percentiles

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See how your **GRE scores** convert to **GRE** percentiles. Use this quick chart to **compare** Verbal and Quant **scores for** MBA admissions.



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